



HUM 102: INTRODUCTION TO PHILOSOPHY SUMMER 2025

FINAL PROJECT INDIVIDUAL REFLECTION

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GROUP B

SEC:04

Our project focused on John Locke's ideas of the social contract, justice, and the difference between absolute and liberal monarchy. Through local tragedies such as the Rana Plaza factory collapse and the 2018 student road safety protests, we connected Locke's philosophy to Bangladesh's July Revolution of 2024, showing how years of injustice built up to a turning point where citizens reclaimed their right to consent and justice.

In this project, I naturally took on the role of a leader. I initiated meetings with our group and guided discussions so everyone understood their tasks. I drafted the main script for the documentary and distributed it evenly among the members. I also created the 30-second introduction and outro, giving the documentary structure and flow. Since most of my teammates were not confident with editing, I took on that responsibility as well. I completed my own portion, and also helped another member fix her part so that the transition between our parts felt smooth. I then merged, adjusted, and polished all the video clips my teammates sent me into one coherent documentary before submission.

Challenges did come up along the way. A few teammates did not follow the instructions properly and one also caused a copyright issue, which created extra work for me and delayed the progress. I tried to remain calm while patiently explaining things to them again and resolved the issues to keep the project moving forward. Although handling all the editing, intro, and outro required more time and effort, I was glad that the documentary came out well.

My main contribution was explaining Social Contract. I introduced Locke's central ideas and linked them to Bangladesh's history of injustice by asking, 'What makes power just, and who should it serve?'. I explained Locke's belief that governments exist only because people consent to be governed and highlighted his warning about what happens when rulers break the trust of

the people. This section was important because it built the bridge between Bangladesh's struggles and Locke's philosophy.

Personally, I found Locke's ideas inspiring, though written in the seventeenth century, his thoughts on consent, rights, and government felt surprisingly modern. I could connect them to my own belief that governments must serve the people, not rule over them. Looking at my own country, I realized how tragedies like Rana Plaza or the student road safety protests symbolized broken contracts between people and power. The July Revolution, in that sense, wasn't just about politics but Locke's philosophy coming to life. We are moving from absolute monarchy toward a liberal system built on consent. But as inspiring as Locke's ideas are, in reality power is rarely given up so easily once rulers have it and that's why moments like the July Revolution become inevitable.